



Social networking - Taming the 'essential' beast!

We all spend several hours on it, but do we really know how to make the most of it?

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Love it or hate it, there really isn't a way to ignore it. Social Networking (read Facebook, Twitter, and then some) has made a space for itself in our lives. Here are some tips to help you slim down, widen out and secure your entire social experience.

1 MULTIPLE SOCIAL NETWORKS, IN ONE APP

Facebook, Twitter, Google Buzz and Foursquare – all networks available within one app. TweetDeck helps save time, integrates multiple timelines into one, and makes replying less of a pain. Download for iOS devices, Android, PC, and as an add-on for Google Chrome. Download- <http://www.tweetdeck.com/>



Get your social networking feeds at one place

2 TWEAK WHO SEES WHAT ON FACEBOOK

Facebook's privacy settings, by default, aren't very secure and some tweaks will make your profile a lot more secure. Click on the Account tab on your FB home page. Go to Privacy Settings > Sharing on Facebook settings > Customize settings. Here you can set who can see what on your profile (relationship status, posts, photos, etc.), who can, and what all should be completely hidden.



Tweak your security settings on Facebook. Select visibility from four options- everyone, friends, friends of friends and customise. The customise setting lets you select exceptions such as a list of friends.

3 SECURE FACEBOOK

In the account settings, you get two critical settings, which we suggest you should enable. First is "Secure Browsing (https)" and the second is "send me an email when an unrecognised device tries to access my account". These will be found in Account > Account Settings > Account tab > Account Security.

4 VIEW YOUR PROFILE AS A FRIEND

With privacy settings it gets really confusing who can see what. So Facebook lets you see how your profile looks to a particular friend?

Go to Account > Privacy settings > View settings > View my profile

5 VIEW PHOTOS THE OLD SCHOOL WAY

Don't like the new photo viewer on Facebook? You can quickly revert to the old one. Open the first picture in a series in a new tab you will go back to the traditional method of viewing pics.

6 GET RID OF UNUSED APPS

Any apps you may have downloaded but aren't using anymore, do pose a risk to your data. Delete them! Click on the Account tab on your FB home page, go to Privacy Settings > Apps.

Select each app, and define what data it can access, or delete them completely.

7 IM THE NEW HANGOUT ZONE

While IM wasn't really considered an integral part of social networking, it has now joined the party. For BlackBerry users, the BlackBerry Messenger (BBM) rocks. The rest of the smartphone community can use WhatsApp on their phones. The messenger gets registered via the sim-card, and instantly connects to everyone on your contacts list who is registered on WhatsApp.

8 TAGGING MULTIPLE PEOPLE

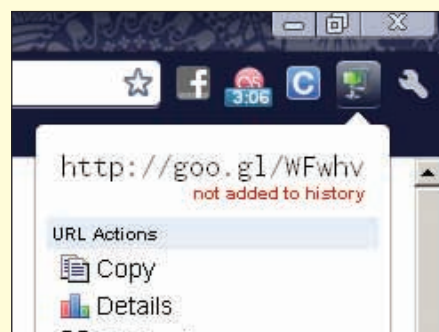
Got a post that may be interesting to a bunch of friends? Tag them in that post itself. To tag, write "@" and then the friend name. You will see the name get highlighted in blue once the tagging is complete.

9 REPLY BY MAIL

Whenever a Facebook friend sends you a message, or comments on your pictures, it also shows up on your email inbox provided notifications are on. You can reply to that from the email itself and the comment will be added to your tagged photo. If you aren't getting these mails, activate email notifications in the account settings. Psst this is a great way to get around office-wide Facebook blocking.

10 SHORTEN URL AND SAVE CHARACTERS

If you post quite a few links on Twitter (and even Facebook), better get a URL shortener extension for your web browser. Once installed, click on the icon, copy the shortened URL into the post and voila! Save characters and time. Download <http://goo.gl/WFwhv>



Make use of short URLs to share more!

